



HEBS Lagos 2026 Concept Note

Inaugural Lagos Edition

October 23 to 25, 2026, Lagos, Nigeria

Official concept note prepared for partners, exhibitors, sponsors, and media.

Event Overview

The Hair Education Beauty Summit (HEBS) is an international platform for beauty, culture, and creative enterprise. HEBS launched in **New Jersey, USA in 2024** and returned in **2025 with a sold-out edition** that established its reputation internationally. Following those earlier United States editions, HEBS staged another sold-out edition from **2–4 May 2026**.

In October 2026 the summit comes home. **HEBS Lagos 2026** will mark the event's fourth edition and its Lagos debut: three days of education, competition, exhibition, and cultural programming, hosted at two venues on the Lekki-Epe corridor of Lagos.

The Lagos edition is broader than the editions before it. Alongside hair, barbering, braiding, makeup, nails, and fashion, the 2026 programme adds **cultural food and live music competition**, and is built in partnership with the tourism and hospitality identity of the Epe region that hosts it.

The summit brings together the full value chain of the beauty and creative economy under one roof, including hairstylists, barbers, braiders, makeup artists, nail technicians, fashion designers, chefs, caterers, seafood and cultural food vendors, vocalists and music creatives, educators, salon owners, manufacturers, distributors, investors, tourism and hospitality stakeholders, and brand leaders from Nigeria, across Africa, and the diaspora.

It is where **education meets opportunity, creativity meets commerce, culture meets industry, and Nigerian talent connects with the global marketplace.**

At a Glance

Dates	October 23 to 25, 2026 (three days)
City	Lagos, Nigeria
Expected attendance	3,000+

Championship prize pool	\$80,000 USD / ₦112,000,000
Competition programme	Five competition tracks covering beauty, barbering, braiding, cultural food, and live vocal performance
Format	Education, exhibition, competition, panels, networking, cultural food, live music, and hospitality experiences

Date and Venue

HEBS Lagos 2026 runs across two official venues.

HEBS Welcome Beach Pre-Party

Friday, October 23, 2026, 2:00 PM to 7:00 PM

NJS Royale Beach Resort, Lagos, Nigeria

An opening celebration with live entertainment, hospitality, and first-night networking for delegates, sponsors, competitors, and invited guests.

HEBS Main Summit, Day One

Saturday, October 24, 2026, 12:00 Noon to 6:00 PM

NJS Royale Events Center, Richland Garden Estate, Lekki-Epe Expressway, Lagos, Nigeria

Exhibition floor, education sessions, panel discussions, championship competition, cultural food tasting, and live vocal competition.

HEBS Main Summit, Day Two

Sunday, October 25, 2026, 11:00 AM to 5:00 PM

NJS Royale Events Center, Richland Garden Estate, Lekki-Epe Expressway, Lagos, Nigeria

Exhibition continues, alongside masterclasses, panels, cultural food tasting, and the Live Championship Finals.

Exhibition days are **October 24 and 25, 2026**. The Main Summit venue offers three activated floors, a main stage, masterclass spaces, a cultural food and tasting area, and a dedicated exhibition and vendor floor.

Theme and Positioning

Where Nigeria's Beauty Industry Meets the World.

Education, innovation, competition, business, and culture, all under one roof.

HEBS Lagos is built as a platform for Nigeria's beauty and creative industries, positioning the country as a serious destination for beauty, culture, entrepreneurship, and international collaboration.

The 2026 edition widens that platform. Beauty, fashion, hair, food, music, tourism, and hospitality are not separate economies in Nigeria. They are the same creative economy, powered by the same entrepreneurs, serving the same audience, and carrying the same cultural story. HEBS Lagos 2026 programmes them together: the salon floor, the kitchen, the runway, and the stage in one venue, across one weekend.

The 2026 edition is also a homecoming. An industry built and proven in the diaspora returns to the culture that shaped it, bringing international standards, international buyers, and international attention with it, and doing so in a region of Lagos whose own identity is built on tourism, hospitality, fishing, and food.

What Sets HEBS Apart

1. **Industry fusion.** A single platform where hairstylists, barbers, braiders, makeup artists, nail technicians, fashion designers, chefs, cultural food vendors, vocalists, and educators work alongside each other and alongside global influencers, rather than in separate events.
2. **Practical education.** Sessions are built around technical skills and real business application, so what attendees learn can be used immediately.
3. **A serious competition purse.** An **\$80,000 USD (₦112,000,000)** cumulative championship prize pool, the largest in African beauty competition, staged as a full production with music, lighting, and a live audience.
4. **Culture on the programme, not on the poster.** Local food, seafood heritage, and live music are competition categories in their own right, with their own judges, their own stage time, and their own prizes.
5. **International exchange.** Global beauty trends brought to Lagos and blended with African influence, creating genuine creative exchange and new commercial contacts.

Objectives

HEBS Lagos 2026 is built to deliver against seven objectives.

1. **Bridge education with opportunity.** Deliver technical training, mentorship, and access to current global trends and product innovation for Nigerian and African professionals.
2. **Connect professionals worldwide.** Create a hub where stylists, barbers, braiders, makeup artists, nail technicians, chefs, music creatives, educators, and brand leaders can meet and build lasting commercial relationships.
3. **Showcase and reward excellence.** Stage Africa's highest-value beauty championship, giving strong talent a professional platform, credible judging, and real exposure.
4. **Drive commercial growth.** Connect exhibitors, manufacturers, distributors, and food and hospitality vendors directly to a concentrated, qualified audience and to new distribution channels.
5. **Celebrate and commercialise local culture.** Give the food, seafood, music, and hospitality traditions of the host region a professional competitive platform, and turn cultural pride into visibility, bookings, and business for local vendors and creatives.
6. **Position Lagos internationally.** Establish the city, and the Lekki-Epe tourism corridor within it, as an emerging beauty, culture, and destination-event location that attracts delegates, media, and investment.
7. **Support the next generation.** Help keep the future of beauty, grooming, fashion, food, and creative enterprise in Nigeria inclusive, innovative, and grounded in technical skill.

Target Audience

Expected attendance is 3,000+ beauty, culture, and creative professionals, educators, creators, and consumers from Nigeria, West Africa, and the wider HEBS community, including international competitors and delegates from the United States, the United Kingdom, and across West Africa.

Professional Attendees

Salon owners, master stylists, barbers, braiders, makeup artists, nail technicians, natural hair stylists, locticians, fashion designers, fashion stylists, creative directors, beauty educators, students, and apprentices.

Food and Hospitality Attendees

Food vendors, chefs, caterers, seafood vendors, cultural food entrepreneurs, restaurateurs, catering businesses, and hospitality operators.

Music and Performance Attendees

Vocalists, music creatives, performers, producers, artist managers, and entertainment professionals.

Commercial and Institutional Attendees

Global beauty brands, investors, manufacturers, distributors, brand founders, creative entrepreneurs, tourism and hospitality stakeholders, and industry media.

Community and Cultural Audience

The Epe community and its cultural representatives, beauty and food consumers, cultural attendees, and the wider Lagos creative community, drawn by the competition production, runway presentations, cultural food programming, and pre-party programming.

Epe Cultural and Tourism Activation

HEBS Lagos 2026 is hosted on the Lekki-Epe corridor, in a part of Lagos State known for its tourism and hospitality economy, its fishing communities, and one of the strongest seafood and cultural food traditions in the country. The 2026 edition is built to reflect that identity rather than sit apart from it.

Two new competition categories carry the activation. The **Taste of Culture Food Tasting Competition** puts Epe's seafood and cultural cooking on a judged stage in front of thousands of attendees, and the **Mic Drop Vocalist Competition** gives local and visiting vocal talent a professional main-stage platform. Both categories are held on the exhibition days, in the same venue, in front of the same audience, judges, sponsors, and media as the beauty championships.

The intent is straightforward. Cooks, caterers, seafood vendors, cultural food entrepreneurs, vocalists, and music creatives receive the same standard of platform, judging, production, and commercial exposure that HEBS already gives to stylists, barbers, and braiders.

A proposed Epe community sponsorship will support **up to 200 contestants** by covering their entry participation, creating access for local talent and strengthening community participation. Contestant allocation across categories will be confirmed with the sponsor ahead of registration.

Beyond competition, the activation is designed to deliver measurable local value: visibility for Epe as a destination for food, hospitality, and cultural tourism; trade for local food vendors, caterers, transport operators, and hospitality businesses across the event weekend; a route to market for cultural food entrepreneurs seeking catering contracts, retail listings, and media coverage; and a recurring annual platform that returns to the region each year rather than a single visit.

Competition Categories

HEBS Lagos 2026 stages **five competition tracks**: three Signature Competitions, the Barber Championship, the Braiding Championship, the Taste of Culture Food Tasting Competition, and the Mic Drop Vocalist Competition. The three championship tracks carry a combined prize pool of **\$80,000 USD (₦112,000,000)**.

Signature Competitions

Live Championship Finals, October 25, 2026, at NJS Royale Events Center.

Combined prize pool: \$22,500 USD (₦31,500,000), which is \$7,500 (₦10,500,000) per category.

Prizes per category: 1st place \$4,000 (₦5,600,000), 2nd place \$2,500 (₦3,500,000), 3rd place \$1,000 (₦1,400,000).

Fashion Runway Competition: **Roots to Royalty**

Roots to Royalty celebrates the journey from cultural heritage to modern-day royalty. Designers create an original, runway-ready look inspired by ancestry, legacy, leadership, and the spirit of Lagos, using regal silhouettes, bold colour, rich fabric, cultural influence, symbolic detail, and statement accessories. Each look should honour its roots while presenting a fresh, elevated take on royalty, with cultural inspiration represented thoughtfully and respectfully.

Makeup Artistry Competition: **Bridal Beauty**

Bridal Beauty focuses on creating a radiant, elegant, wedding-ready look. Artists present their interpretation of the modern bride while complementing the model's features, skin tone, and personal beauty, anywhere from soft and timeless to bold and glamorous. Judged on complexion work, balanced colour, clean application, attention to detail, and long-lasting wear.

Nail Artistry Competition: **Gilded Heritage**

Gilded Heritage explores culture, craftsmanship, and luxury through nail design. Artists create a complete set inspired by heritage, traditional patterns, precious metals, textiles, jewellery, and cultural detail, using rich colour, gold accents, sculpted elements, intricate pattern, embellishment, and creative texture. The finished set should be original, balanced, technically clean, and a modern take on culture and elegance.

Live round judging: creative concept and storytelling 30 percent, technical skill and precision 25 percent, visual impact and innovation 25 percent, stage presence and performance 20 percent. Each finalist has five minutes on stage in front of the judges, media, sponsors, and a live audience.

Barber Championship

October 24, 2026, at NJS Royale Events Center.

Track prize pool: \$27,500 USD (₦38,500,000) across four divisions.

Official Equipment Partner: Men't Pro Tools™. All competitors use HEBS-supplied clippers and trimmers on stage. Personal cutting machinery is not permitted.

Division	Format	Prize Pool
Fast & Flawless Challenge™ , the speed competition	Solo, 15 min	\$5,000 / ₦7,000,000
Battle of the Fades™ , the fade championship	Solo, 30 min	\$5,000 / ₦7,000,000
Freestyle Design Battle™ , art meets barbering	Solo, 60 min	\$7,500 / ₦10,500,000
Barber Games™ , the team battle	Team of 4, 2 hrs	\$10,000 / ₦14,000,000

Africa's biggest barbering competition, bringing together professional and student barbers from Nigeria, Africa, and beyond for a contest of speed, precision, creativity, and technical skill. Open to professionals, students, apprentices, and educators. Minimum age 16. Competitors supply their own models.

Braiding Championship

October 24, 2026, at NJS Royale Events Center.

Track prize pool: \$30,000 USD (₦42,000,000) across four divisions.

Official Styling Partner: PureO Natural Products™. Styling and finishing products are supplied by HEBS. Competitors bring their own combs, brushes, tools, and extensions.

Division	Format	Prize Pool
Fast & Flawless Braiding Challenge™ , speed and precision	Solo, 30 min	\$5,000 / ₦7,000,000
Braids & Fades Showdown™ , featured collaborative track	1 barber and 1 braider, 60 min	\$7,500 / ₦10,500,000
Traditional Braiding Championship™ , culture and heritage	Solo, 60 min	\$7,500 / ₦10,500,000
Freestyle Braid Art Championship™ , creativity without limits	Solo, 75 min	\$10,000 / ₦14,000,000

Africa's premier braiding competition, celebrating the skill, creativity, speed, and innovation of professional braiders from across Africa and beyond, while honouring one of the oldest beauty traditions. Open to professional and student braiders, salon owners, natural hair stylists, locticians, and international competitors. Minimum age 16.

Taste of Culture Food Tasting Competition

October 24 and 25, 2026, at NJS Royale Events Center.

Entry fee: **\$100 USD / ₦140,000.**

Awards: **up to \$10,000 USD (₦14,000,000)** in cash prizes.

Present your best cultural signature dish. Taste of Culture is a cultural food competition built around the seafood and fish traditions that Epe and its fishing communities are known for, and around the wider cultural cooking of Lagos and Nigeria. Competitors prepare and present a signature dish for tasting on the exhibition floor across both event days.

Two awards are contested. **Judges’ Choice** is decided by a professional panel assessing flavour, technique, presentation, and the cultural story behind the dish. **People’s Choice** is decided by the summit audience, giving attendees a direct vote in the outcome.

Open to chefs, caterers, restaurateurs, seafood and cultural food vendors, catering businesses, and home cooks. Competition format, tasting logistics, and full judging criteria are confirmed on the official registration portal.

Mic Drop Vocalist Competition

October 24, 2026, at NJS Royale Events Center.

Entry fee: **\$50 USD / ₦70,000.**

Awards: **up to \$5,000 USD (₦7,000,000)** in cash prizes.

Mic Drop is a live vocal competition staged on the HEBS main stage, in front of the judges, sponsors, media, and the full summit audience. Competitors perform live and are judged on vocal ability and performance, competing for up to \$5,000 in cash prizes.

Open to vocalists and music creatives from Lagos, across Nigeria, and beyond, at professional and emerging level. Performance format, round structure, judging criteria, and time allowance are confirmed on the official registration portal.

Prize Pool

\$80,000 USD / ₦112,000,000

The largest prize purse in African beauty competition history.

Track	USD	NGN
Signature Competitions: Fashion Runway, Makeup Artistry, Nail Artistry	\$22,500	₦31,500,000
Barber Championship (4 divisions)	\$27,500	₦38,500,000
Braiding Championship (4 divisions)	\$30,000	₦42,000,000
Total championship prize pool	\$80,000	₦112,000,000

Cultural competition awards are additional to the championship prize pool and are staged as part of the Epe Cultural and Tourism Activation.

Cultural Competition	Awards
Taste of Culture Food Tasting Competition	Up to \$10,000 USD (₦14,000,000)
Mic Drop Vocalist Competition	Up to \$5,000 USD (₦7,000,000)

Alongside the prize money, winners receive the HEBS Championship Trophy, recognition across HEBS platforms, media coverage and editorial features, brand collaboration and sponsorship opportunities, and exposure to judges and industry leaders.

Sponsor and Exhibitor Opportunities

HEBS Lagos 2026 gives brands direct access to the decision-makers of Nigeria's beauty economy, including salon owners, practitioners, educators, distributors, and consumers, across three days in one venue.

Sponsorship Tiers

Diamond \$25,000 USD *(one exclusive slot)*

- Prime "Presented By" branding on the HEBS main stage backdrop
- Opening ceremony and closing gala speaking slots
- 20 × 20 ft exclusive flagship booth with premier entrance positioning
- 10 all-access VIP tickets with backstage Meet and Greet access
- "Presented By" credit across all official event backdrops and media walls
- Logo on all signage, merchandise, and official press materials
- Dedicated social media campaign reaching 100k+ combined
- Full-page feature in the official HEBS 2026 press kit
- Co-branded content creation and post-event media recap
- Unlimited staff vendor badges

Platinum \$15,000 USD

- VIP Lounge presenting sponsor with full naming rights
- Stage branding across all main sessions
- 15 × 15 ft premium booth with priority floor placement
- 6 all-access VIP tickets
- Social media campaign reaching 50k+
- Full-page official program listing
- Brand mention at every stage session

Gold \$5,500 USD

- Masterclass stage sponsorship with naming rights
- 12 × 12 ft booth in the premium floor zone

- 4 all-access VIP tickets
- Product placement in official event gift bags
- Logo on select signage and event materials
- Social media brand post reaching 25k+
- Half-page official program listing

Silver \$2,500 USD

- 10 × 10 ft booth space
- Logo on official website and social media channels
- 2 all-access VIP tickets
- Product placement in event gift bags
- Quarter-page official program listing
- Brand mention during networking segments

Bronze \$1,500 USD

- 8 × 8 ft booth space
- Logo listing on official HEBS website
- 2 general admission tickets
- Product sampling opportunity on vendor floor
- Brand mention in event program

Exhibitor and Vendor Booth Packages

Exhibit days are October 24 and 25, 2026, at NJS Royale Events Center, Lagos.

Package	Investment	Inclusions
Standard Booth	\$1,500 ₦2,100,000	1 table, 2 chairs, and 5 general admission passes
Premium Booth	\$3,000 ₦4,200,000	High-traffic placement, 2 tables, 4 chairs, a social media feature, and 10 general admission passes
Deluxe Booth	\$4,500 ₦6,300,000	Prime location, 4 tables, 6 chairs, featured listing on the event website, VIP networking access, and 15 general admission passes

Optional add-ons. Electricity and Wi-Fi access at \$150 (₦210,000). On-site branding and banner placement from \$550 (₦770,000).

Also available. Official equipment, styling product, hospitality, media, and cultural programming partnerships, structured on request.

All sponsorship and exhibitor packages are confirmed by email, and a formal proposal and invoice follow within 48 hours of enquiry. **Further sponsorship and exhibitor details are available on request.**

Expected Impact

HEBS Lagos is not only a competition. It is an **economic development platform** intended to help Nigerian and African talent build recognised brands through education, investment, innovation, tourism, food, manufacturing, and international partnership.

Economic Empowerment

A platform that supports entrepreneurs, creates jobs, and drives business growth across Nigeria's beauty, food, and creative industries by connecting practitioners to training, capital relationships, and the market access they need to scale.

Tourism and Investment

Attracting international visitors, delegates, competitors, and foreign investment to Lagos, positioning the city and the Lekki-Epe corridor as an emerging beauty, culture, and destination-event location, with direct spillover into hospitality, food service, transport, and local commerce in the host community.

Trade and Partnerships

Strengthening international trade by connecting Nigerian manufacturing, distribution, product innovation, and cultural food enterprise to global markets, buyers, and distribution partners.

Industry Development

Raising the technical standard of the sector through strong education and international benchmarking, and building a repeatable annual platform that grows in value for participants, brands, and the host region each year.

HEBS Lagos 2026 is designed to become **Nigeria's premier annual beauty, fashion, culture, and creative industries summit**, and an anchor event on the African and international industry calendar.

Registration and Participation

For Competitors

The application process runs in four stages.

Stage	Timing	Detail
Registration Opens	Open now	Register at hebseventportal.com/register and pay the entry fee for your chosen category. Open worldwide to fashion designers, fashion stylists, makeup artists, nail artists, creative directors, barbers, braiders, chefs and cultural food entrepreneurs, vocalists, and beauty, culture, and fashion visionaries.
Video Submission and Registration Deadline	October 15, 2026 11:59 PM WAT	Signature Competition entrants submit a 3-minute MP4 or MOV video to casting@hebslagos.com showing their name, category, work-in-progress clips, and a before and after transformation. All registrations and submissions must be complete by the deadline.

Contestant Notification	1 to 3 business days after submission	All entrants are told whether they have been selected for the Live Final Championship.
Live Championship Finals	October 25, 2026	Each Signature finalist has five minutes to present their live interpretation of their category's 2026 theme.

Entry Fees by Category

Entry fees are set per category and per division. Competitors pay only for the categories they enter, and may enter more than one.

Signature Competitions

Fashion Runway, Makeup Artistry, and Nail Artistry.

Category	Entry Fee
Fashion Runway Competition (<i>Roots to Royalty</i>)	\$50 USD / ₦50,000
Makeup Artistry Competition (<i>Bridal Beauty</i>)	\$50 USD / ₦50,000
Nail Artistry Competition (<i>Gilded Heritage</i>)	\$50 USD / ₦50,000

Barber Championship

Fees are set per division, as published on the official registration portal.

Division	Entry Fee
Fast & Flawless Challenge™	\$50 USD / ₦50,000 per competitor
Battle of the Fades™	\$50 USD / ₦50,000 per competitor
Freestyle Design Battle™	\$75 USD / ₦75,000 per competitor
Barber Games™ (team of 4)	\$100 USD / ₦100,000 for the whole team, not per barber

Braiding Championship

Division	Entry Fee
Fast & Flawless Braiding Challenge™	\$50 USD / ₦50,000 per competitor
Braids & Fades Showdown™ (1 barber and 1 braider)	\$50 USD / ₦50,000 for the two-person team, not per person
Traditional Braiding Championship™	\$50 USD / ₦50,000 per competitor
Freestyle Braid Art Championship™	\$75 USD / ₦105,000 per competitor

Cultural Competitions

Category	Entry Fee
Taste of Culture Food Tasting Competition	\$100 USD / ₦140,000 per entry
Mic Drop Vocalist Competition	\$50 USD / ₦70,000 per competitor

Team entries. Two divisions are contested by teams rather than individuals: **Barber Games™** (teams of four) and the **Braids & Fades Showdown™** (one barber and one braider). In both cases a single entry fee registers the entire team. Team members do not pay individually, and the team registers once under one nominated lead competitor.

All entry fees are **non-refundable**. Current fees for every division are confirmed at the point of registration on the official portal. Competitors and finalists arrange and pay for their own travel and lodging to Lagos. HEBS provides the stage production and, where applicable, the official competition equipment and styling products supplied by our partner brands.

For Attendees and Delegates

Pass	Price	Includes
One Day Pass	₦15,000	General admission, all three floors, main stage, education sessions, and exhibitors
Two Days Pass	₦25,000	General admission for two event days, all three floors, main stage, education sessions, and exhibitors
Three Days Pass	₦75,000	Full three-day access including the Pre-Party, networking with industry leaders from the USA and Nigeria, all three floors, main stage, education sessions, and exhibitors
VIP Experience	\$400 ₦560,000 <i>standard \$600</i>	Full three-day VIP clearance, front-row priority seating, exclusive VIP lounge access, Celebrity Meet and Greet, and the official merchandise package

Early-bird rates are available for a limited window and are subject to tier limits.

For Sponsors and Exhibitors

Contact the partnerships team directly for a tailored proposal. Packages are allocated on a first-confirmed basis, and the Diamond tier is limited to a single exclusive partner.

Contact and Call to Action

Partner with HEBS Lagos 2026.

October 23 to 25, 2026, Lagos, Nigeria

Nigeria's beauty industry is among the most creative and commercially active in the world. HEBS Lagos 2026 is where it meets the global market, across three days, in one venue, in front of 3,000+ professionals, competitors, buyers, and media.

Enquiries

Sponsorship and partnerships	info@thehebs.com
Exhibitors and vendors	exhibitors@thehebs.com
Competitions and entries	competitions@hebslagos.com
Competition video submissions	casting@hebslagos.com
Registration portal	hebseventportal.com/register

Telephone / WhatsApp

+1 610 477 9635 (US and WhatsApp)

08148414917 and 08023051810 (Nigeria and WhatsApp)

Support hours are 2:00 PM to 11:00 PM WAT.

Online

hebslagos.com. Instagram, Facebook, and YouTube: @haireducationbeautysummit

Venues

NJS Royale Events Center, Richland Garden Estate, Lekki-Epe Expressway, Lagos, Nigeria (Main Summit, October 24 and 25).

NJS Royale Beach Resort, Lagos, Nigeria (HEBS Welcome Beach Pre-Party, October 23).

Sponsorship proposals and invoices are issued within 48 hours of enquiry. Further sponsorship and exhibitor details are available on request.

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